FIELD GUIDE / PRODUCT & OPERATIONS

Indian Time Bank

How a request becomes verified help

Follow a resident, a coordinator and a volunteer from joining a community to confirming a visit. Then see what happens to the credits, what can go wrong, and which parts the current staff dashboard supports.

01

Whole-system map

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02

One visit, step by step

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03

Dashboard coverage

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PRD v2.0 / Working-tree review / 8 November 2026

The whole service, on one page

Read steps 1–3 across the first row, then 4–6 across the second. One request belongs to one community; each helper has a separate assignment.

1 / STAFF

Set up the community

Central staff create the organization. Local staff enable services and approve people.

2 / RESIDENT

Ask for help

An eligible beneficiary, authorized caregiver or coordinator supplies a service, time and manual address.

3 / MATCHING

Fill a position

Offer to qualified volunteers. Acceptance reserves a slot; unfilled requests widen or reach a coordinator.

4 / VOLUNTEER

Deliver the visit

At the agreed place, start the assignment, do the work, then finish and report minutes.

5 / INDEPENDENT PERSON

Confirm or dispute

The beneficiary, permitted caregiver or independent staff member reviews the work. A dispute goes to staff.

6 / SERVER

Record the outcome

Confirmed minutes earn time credits once. The record retains the host community; the beneficiary pays nothing.

HOW TO READ THIS GUIDE

Core workflows have backend code. “Planned” identifies PRD features without a complete production path. “Pilot check” needs evidence on the deployed system.

One visit, from booking to credit

Illustrative scheduled visit in Kottakkal: Fathima needs help reaching an outpatient appointment. Arjun is an approved volunteer.

01 / FATHIMA

Book for tomorrow

She chooses an enabled accompaniment service and enters the clinic address, ward, PIN and start time.

→

02 / ARJUN

Accept today

Matching starts when Fathima submits. Arjun accepts the offer for tomorrow. They can call to coordinate.

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03 / AT THE CLINIC

Record 40 minutes

Arjun starts and finishes the visit. Work is recorded, but the assignment still awaits independent confirmation.

If Fathima confirms

At the documented default rate of one credit per hour with partial hours, 40 confirmed minutes earns Arjun 0.67 credits. Her balance is unchanged.

If the duration is disputed

The request goes to review. Staff examine the visit and decide the supported minutes before the corresponding award is finalized.

WHY TWO RECORDS?

The request is Fathima’s need. The assignment is Arjun’s commitment. A team may have several assignments for one request.

Who can act, and where

A person can have several approved roles. Permission depends on the organization, the action and the specific record.

Person	What they do	Boundary
Super Admin	Creates organizations, appoints local admins, sets central policy and inspects audits.	Global governance; final internal appeal authority.
Municipality Admin	Appoints coordinators, oversees local operations and decides privileged cases.	Acts within the assigned organization.
Coordinator	Reviews applications, skills and eligibility; dispatches visits and reviews exceptions.	Cannot confirm their own service or approve their own credit investigation.
Volunteer	Accepts or declines offers, delivers visits and records time in the member app.	Requires approved role and relevant verified skills.
Beneficiary	Requests eligible help, confirms delivery or reports a problem.	Eligible assistance is free, even with zero credits.
Caregiver	Acts for a named beneficiary with explicit approval.	Request permission and confirmation permission are separate.
Merchant / sponsor	Planned: merchants redeem local offers; sponsors receive aggregated exports.	Merchants fund discounts. Sponsors have no dashboard login.

Join a community and unlock a role

One verified person has one universal wallet. Opening another community's branded app does not grant membership or carry staff privileges across.

COMMUNITY

Provision and brand

Super Admin sets the organization and its admin. A separately configured, signed Android release is needed for each brand.

→

PERSON

Sign in and apply

Verify the phone. Submit the name, role and application details for this organization; staff review identity and documents.

→

DECISION

Grant local access

Approved membership and a role unlock local actions. Pending or rejected applications do not unlock staff or member privileges.

Volunteer

Claim skills and travel preferences. A coordinator verifies skills. Stated days and times help staff; they are not a weekly scheduling engine.

Beneficiary or caregiver

Eligibility has categories, a review date and a quota. A caregiver also needs the beneficiary's revocable authorization; being family is insufficient.

EXAMPLE

Arjun can volunteer in Kozhikode and coordinate in Kottakkal. His permissions change with the community; his lifetime time-credit balance stays the same.

From the catalogue to a valid request

Central definitions keep services consistent. Local staff choose what their community can provide safely.

CENTRAL

Define the service

Set category, bilingual labels, skills, risk rules and minimum staffing. A proposed new service needs central review.

→

ORGANIZATION

Enable it locally

Set local instructions, safe and preferred headcounts, and coordinator-only dispatch where needed.

→

REQUESTER

Submit the booking

Identify the recipient, select immediate or scheduled help, enter address, ward, PIN, start time and expected duration.

Pass the checks

Verify local membership and authority, active catalogue item, beneficiary eligibility and quota. A coordinator can handle justified exceptions.

If the request fails

An expired eligibility record, revoked caregiver permission or missing manual address stops submission. A home address is not a substitute for the visit address.

SCOPE

Accompaniment and practical help are in scope. The service is not an emergency medical dispatch system.

How volunteers are matched

Both immediate and future requests start matching on submission. Volunteers choose each task; declining an offer is different from cancelling a commitment.

FILTER

Check eligibility

Require active access, an approved volunteer role, verified skills and no conflicting assignment. Sensitive services go to staff.

→

RANK

Search nearby

Use verified residence or fresh, consented GPS. Rank suitable candidates by location and policy; there is no continuous tracking.

→

OFFER

Reserve or expand

An accepted offer reserves a position. Expired or declined offers leave it open. Later rounds widen the search; staff can intervene.

Default search radii

3 km → 7 km → 15 km → coordinator. Scheduled and immediate offers have different deadlines. A worker processes due rounds when background workers are enabled.

Community boundaries

Routine dispatch is local. The PRD permits explicitly authorized community drives; this does not grant ordinary access to another community's data.

WHEN NO ONE ACCEPTS

The coordinator can call an eligible volunteer, arrange a different time or record that the request expired unmatched.

What happens when the plan changes

Read the request and its assignments separately. A staffed request is not a completed visit; a finished assignment can still be unconfirmed.

Event	Request or assignment changes	Next responsible person
Offer accepted	Below minimum: partially staffed. At minimum: matched. Preferred staffing can be higher.	Coordinator checks staffing; assigned volunteers attend.
Time changes	Record the old and new time; affected commitments need reconfirmation.	Volunteer accepts a fresh offer for the changed time.
Withdrawal / cancel	Before start, withdrawal reopens a position. Request cancellation closes active commitments and records why.	Match again or notify affected parties. Review repeated late cancellations or no-shows.
Visit starts	Once work begins, ordinary reschedule, cancellation and withdrawal actions are blocked.	Volunteer finishes and submits minutes.
Work finishes	In progress can mean actively working, awaiting confirmation, or under review.	Independent verifier or reviewer decides. Close when outstanding assignments are settled.

Verify once; award once

A timer records a claim. Independent confirmation authorizes a reward. Those are different events with different actors.

VOLUNTEER

Start and finish

Record the actual visit, minutes and notes. A volunteer cannot confirm their own work, even if they also hold a staff role.

→

INDEPENDENT VERIFIER

Confirm or flag

Beneficiary, authorized caregiver or independent staff checks the claim. Disputes or suspicious durations need review.

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SERVER

Post the award

Apply the service rate, multiplier and partial-hour rule. Confirmation and credit posting succeed together; retries cannot pay twice.

One wallet across communities

The ledger records the originating organization and assignment. A member approved in a second city keeps the same balance and history.

Corrections keep the history

Do not rewrite an old award. Record a hold, investigation, authorized release or correction as a new entry. Frozen earnings are not spendable.

FREE ASSISTANCE

Verification rewards the volunteer. It never bills the eligible beneficiary. Lifetime time credits are separate from merchant loyalty coins.

Where credits can go

Time credits can be held, donated or used voluntarily. A debit must never become a second payment for the same visit.

Path	Sequence	Guardrail
Member donation	Choose a verified member or approved community pool → check spendable balance → debit and credit together.	No self-donation or overspending. A retry with the same operation key replays the original transfer.
Voluntary funding	After confirmed completion, the eligible payer offers their own credits; authorized staff may use a local pool.	Once per request, up to its verified award. Even partial funding closes further funding. No beneficiary payment is required.
Suspected fraud	Identify the source entry → hold available disputed credits → investigate linked downstream transfers.	Hold only traceable, available value; preserve the original entries.
Decision	A separate authorized resolver releases or corrects the hold and writes the audit record.	The investigator cannot approve their own decision. Review authority and available balances again before posting.

Teams, handoffs and merchant coins

The backend already models headcounts and individual assignments. The PRD's complete team, transfer and merchant journeys are later milestones.

Scenario	Intended flow	Outcome
Simultaneous team	Invite eligible teammates or match open positions. Start when the safe minimum is present on-site. Each helper records their own time; someone else verifies it.	Each completing volunteer receives rewards only after independent verification.
Below safe minimum	A volunteer leaves mid-service → alert coordinator → halt hazardous tasks; keep position open.	Only safe activities may continue. Recruit a replacement.
Sequential handoff	Volunteer requests replacement. Routine transfer rematches; sensitive or urgent transfers need coordinator review.	Only the finishing volunteer earns service credits and service-related coins for that assignment.
Merchant redemption	Merchant proposes offer → local admin approves → member uses coins → merchant scans QR or enters a single-use code.	Online validation prevents reuse. Merchant funds the discount; no reimbursement or time-credit conversion.
Recognition	Verified service, milestones, feedback, reliability and civic engagement inform recognition.	Badges and certificates are privacy-controlled; leaderboards are opt-in. Local campaigns need central approval.

Safety, appeals and account changes

Restrictions exist in the staff system. The complete confidential case and appeal workflows below are planned product rules.

Trigger	Who acts next	Result
Safety alert	Volunteer or beneficiary alerts the assigned coordinator; may pause or end the visit.	Only the coordinator may authorize a restart; participants can decline.
Complaint or appeal	Routine case → coordinator. Against coordinator → municipal admin. Against admin → Super Admin.	Keep evidence confidential. Appeal to the next authority; Super Admin is final internally.
Suspension or ban	Coordinator investigates; municipal admin decides suspension/reinstatement or a permanent ban. A ban is appealable centrally.	Freeze wallet operations, retain balances. No automatic reinstatement just because time passed. An overturned ban restores access.
Local revocation	Municipality removes local membership.	Other approved memberships and the universal wallet survive. Distinguish this from a platform-wide ban.
Lost phone / death	Verify identity before changing the number. Verify an OTP-protected nominee change; investigate disputes. On death, verify the nominee.	Recover the same account. On death, halt activity, transfer remaining time credits to the verified nominee, retire coins, archive history.
Duplicate identity	Flag a suspected match → coordinator investigates → municipal admin approves closure.	No automatic merge. Freeze credits and coins in the closed duplicate rather than moving them.

Offline, reporting and privacy

These PRD features explain how the service should work beyond the connected pilot. They are not promises about the deployed app.

DEVICE / PLANNED

Capture offline

Coordinator captures registration or volunteer records timer events locally. A safety alert without a receipt stays “undelivered.”

→

RECONNECT / PLANNED

Retry safely

Use an encrypted queue and one operation ID per action. Show pending, success or failure; retry without duplicating records.

→

SERVER / REQUIRED

Finalize online

Server resolves conflicts and confirms authoritative records. Approval, wallet posting, redemption and admin decisions stay online.

Reporting audience

Municipal admins export local PDF, spreadsheet or CSV reports. Central staff see cross-community totals. Sponsors receive periodic aggregate exports, not accounts.

Access and communication

Limit access to addresses and care details. Plan English and Malayalam, readable contrast, keyboard and screen-reader access. Use push/SMS and opt-in WhatsApp.

FUNDING BOUNDARY

Government, NGO or CSR support may fund operations. There is no compulsory citizen fee or budget-spending module. Merchants fund their own offers.

What runs behind the screens

The phone and dashboard share a backend. The server is responsible for deciding who can act and what is recorded.

PEOPLE

Android and web

Members use the community's Flutter app. Staff use a Next.js dashboard; phone sign-in and a staff email code protect panel access when required.

→

SERVICE

Shared NestJS API

Check identity, active organization, role and ownership. Separate modules handle requests, matching, notifications, confirmation and credits.

→

RECORDS

PostgreSQL

Global: person, verified identity, universal wallet. Local: membership, catalogue, request and assignment. Ledger entries retain their origin.

Release path

Test, build versioned images, approve release, migrate and check health. A branded Android package has its own configuration, signing and release lifecycle.

Operational targets

Monitor errors, queue and database health. Plan daily encrypted off-server backups and a restore drill; hardening target: 10,000 users and 300 concurrent.

ORGANIZATION-SPECIFIC PUSH

Device registration and dispatch carry the community context so an offer goes to the corresponding app. Real-device delivery remains a pilot check.

Is the staff dashboard up to date?

Mostly, yes. The core staff workflows call real backend routes. The most visible drift is how request stages and people's names are presented.

Area	Web implementation	Assessment
Sign-in & administration	Cookie session gateway, Firebase/OTP sign-in, staff email challenge, organizations, role grants, restrictions and audit.	Connected. Environment configuration and deployed sign-in still need live checks.
Member review	Membership drawer reads names and ID status; staff can edit names and verify or reject identity.	Aligned in current working tree. New identity backend files and dashboard edits are uncommitted.
Requests & matching	Staff create bookings, select candidates, dispatch, reschedule, cancel, progress rounds and review disputes.	Partial: list displays raw status, not the new awaiting-confirmation / under-review stage.
People pickers	Request and credit tools still label people using membership number or phone. Membership search on the API also accepts a full name.	Partial: name display and search hints have not caught up everywhere.
Catalogue & wallets	Real API operations cover eligibility, caregiver review, zones, skills, local catalogue, pools, ledger history, funding and credit review.	Connected for staff operations. Member offer acceptance, timers and gifting belong to the mobile app.
Future PRD areas	Merchant redemption, full safety/appeals, sponsor exports and offline workflows are not complete staff journeys.	Later milestones, not evidence of a broken link to an existing admin API.

Working tree: apps/web/src/app/page.tsx; components/coordinator-requests.tsx, time-credits.tsx; apps/api/src/requests/request-view.ts

What is built, and what comes next

Status describes the local working tree and the updated PRD, not a production certification. Older audit notes describe earlier versions.

Stage	Scope	Readiness
M1–M2	Foundation, sign-in, local roles, memberships, identity review, eligibility and caregivers.	Core code present. SIM recovery and nominee lifecycle remain open.
M3–M4	Catalogue, requests, matching worker, visits, independent confirmation, credit ledger, donations and controls.	Core code present. New identity and community push changes need deployment together with migrations.
First pilot	Kottakkal: a supervised group, low-risk services, initially scheduled and mostly single-volunteer visits.	Verify actual phone sign-in, staff email, app-closed push, backup restoration and human sign-off.
Second community	Separate branding, app identifier and release; local access gates and community-specific push delivery.	Prove separation with two real builds before broader rollout.
M5–M8	Teams/transfers; loyalty/merchants; safety, appeals, closures and reports; offline reliability.	Planned or partial; core assignment support does not complete the later workflows.
M9	Capacity, recovery, monitoring, security, accessibility and Malayalam validation.	Hardening and field validation remain; passing unit tests do not certify a pilot.

Where to find the rules

The PRD defines the intended product. Feature notes explain narrower workflows; dated audits and setup guides describe the version they tested.

Topic	Documents in docs/	Use them for
Product & structure	PRD.md; MILESTONES.md; ARCHITECTURE.md; DEV_SETUP.md; APPLICATION_WORKFLOW.md	Business rules, milestone scope, architecture and a narrative overview.
Access & dashboard	FIREBASE_PHONE_AUTH.md; MEMBERSHIP_APPLICATIONS.md; LIVE_ADMIN_DASHBOARD.md; INTERFACE_QA_2026-10-31.md	Sign-in, onboarding, staff permissions and historical UI evidence.
Service delivery	MILESTONE_3_SPEC.md; SERVICE_CATALOGUE_DASHBOARD.md; COORDINATOR_REQUESTS.md; MATCHING_CONCURRENCY.md; ASSIGNMENT_HISTORY_QA.md; SERVICE_COMPLETION.md	Dispatch rules, rescheduling, concurrency, visit history and independent verification.
Credit operations	TIME_CREDITS.md; CREDIT_DONATIONS.md; CREDIT_CONTROLS.md	Awards, donations, optional funding, holds, investigation and correction.
Release evidence	PILOT_CHECKLIST.md; TEST_SERVER.md; SECURITY_STABILIZATION.md; dated audit and Flutter integration reports.	Release checks and historical findings. Check current code before treating an old gap as present.

Source folder: docs/ • All paths below are project-relative document names.